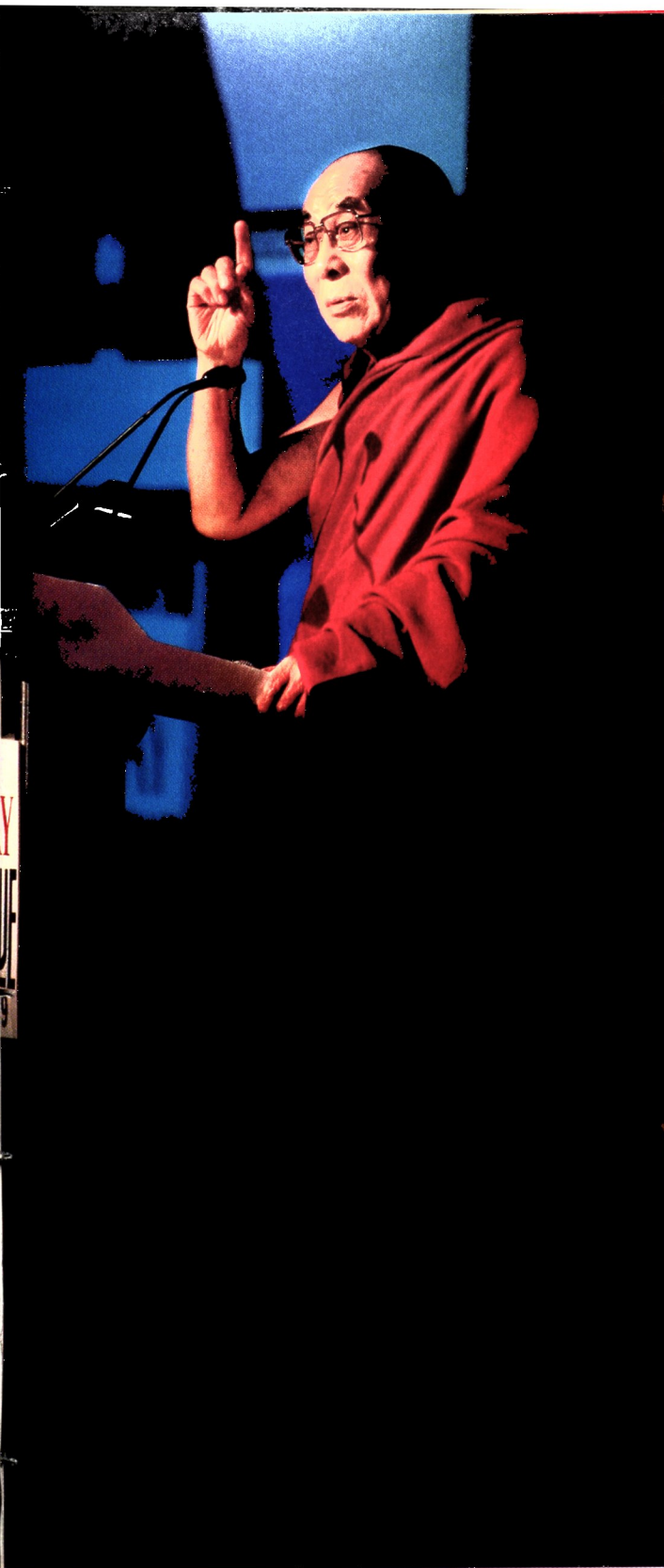




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brotherhood and a sense of universal responsibility are more significant than anything else. This is not just a religious matter, but the key method to deal with the new reality. If our smart brain balances out with warm-heartedness, then our knowledge and intelligence become constructive. People usually pay adequate attention to the importance of education and health, but not to warm-heartedness. That, I think, is something we take for granted. And that is a mistake. Biologically it can be taken for granted. Everybody has a seed of compassion in them, because we are social animals. But that's not enough. We need to pay more attention and put in more effort to promote these human values.

I feel, there should be three ways of promoting compassion: First, the concept of the creator. When a child is born, he doesn't know the mother. But there is spontaneous, immense love and compassion from the mother and unquestioning care. That's one approach. Another way is non-theistic: The law of causality. Our every experience—pain and pleasure—takes place because of our actions. If you take positive, helpful and compassionate actions towards others, you get positive consequences. For harmful actions born out of anger or hatred, you have to face negative results. So restrain from harming others and develop compassion.

Then there is the third method: The secular way. Simply use your common experience and common sense. We all know that those who grow up with full affection enjoy better health, a calmer mental state and have a greater potential to show affection to others. The latest scientific findings, too, show that our good health is linked to positive emotions, while hatred, fear and strong anger eat into our immunity system. In a medical conference at the New York University, scientists reported that those who often think "I, me, mine" have a greater risk of heart attack. Again research carried out among a group of young monkeys showed that those that grew up around their mothers were happier and playful. Those that were kept separated were always in a bad mood and ready to quarrel. We are the same. A self-centred attitude closes the inner doors of the mind and begets fear, distrust, ultimately loneliness and hopelessness. Compassion opens our inner door—trust, love and a wider perspective. Your own problem becomes less significant and more bearable. We can use the common experiences and latest scientific findings to educate